Quolin

Quolin automates the client checks a regulated firm must run before a client can buy a complex product, and keeps every client compliant after that. It onboards, classifies, assesses and limits each client, whether retail, accredited or institutional, then monitors, records and reports so the firm can prove every decision to its regulator. We start with digital assets.

01 Who we sell to

First: licensed digital-asset brokers and trading platforms

Firms that let their own clients buy digital assets: about 38 licensees in Singapore, 13 licensed platforms in Hong Kong, and 45+ firms applying in Australia. The buyer is the head of compliance; the users are the compliance and onboarding teams.

Next: banks, private banks, wealth platforms, external asset managers

Firms that want to add digital assets and other complex products for their existing clients, who already trust their name. Larger contracts, slower to buy, so they come once we have paying references and security certification.

02 The problem: client checks are manual, costly and hard to prove

Before a client can buy a complex product, the firm must decide whether that client is allowed to, up to what amount, under which country's rules, and record why. After that it must re-check clients when rules or circumstances change. Today this runs on forms, spreadsheets, consultants and compliance staff. The cost is the same for a small client as a large one, so firms either turn smaller clients away or run a tick-box that will not survive an inspection.

9%

of UK adults got advice on pensions or investments in the past year. The FCA estimates about 23 million people are underserved.

A$4,668

median ongoing advice fee in Australia, 2025, up 67% in five years: careful judgement is priced for the wealthy.

Accredited only

DBS limits its digital exchange and digital-asset options to accredited and institutional clients.

03 Why now: regulators require these checks for every retail client

MARKET	DATE	WHAT FIRMS MUST DO
Singapore	19 Jun 2025	Test each retail client's understanding of the risks before letting them trade digital assets
Hong Kong	In force	Assess each retail client's knowledge and set a personal limit on how much they can hold
Australia	9 Apr 2027	Digital-asset platforms come under financial-services licensing and conduct rules
UK	25 Oct 2027	New digital-asset regime starts; firms are applying for authorisation now
EU	In force	MiCA requires suitability checks for digital-asset advice and portfolio management

04 How Quolin works

Example. Mei, a retail client in Singapore, wants to buy bitcoin through her licensed broker. The broker sends Quolin her details and her test answers; Quolin does the rest.

STEP 1 · ONBOARD

Classify and assess

Identifies Mei as a retail client, runs the risk test her regulator requires, and checks which country's rules apply.

STEP 2 · DECIDE

Allow, block or refer

Allows, blocks or sends her case to a person, with plain-English reasons and the maximum she may hold.

STEP 3 · KEEP COMPLIANT

Record, monitor, report

Records every decision so it can be replayed years later, re-checks Mei when rules change, and produces the regulator's reports.

The firm stays in charge. It signs off the rules and owns every client decision. Quolin never gives advice, holds assets or executes trades.

Sources: FCA Financial Lives and targeted support statements (2026); Adviser Ratings 2025 (survey); DBS; MAS Guidelines PS-G03; SFC; ASIC; FCA; EU Regulation 2023/1114; MAS and SFC registers.

05 First product: Singapore's Risk Awareness Assessment

Since June 2025, Singapore's regulator (MAS) has expected every licensed digital-asset firm to give each retail client a **Risk Awareness Assessment** before they trade: a test that checks the client understands what they are buying. Firms already run it, mostly by hand. We automate it end to end: a test signed off by a qualified reviewer, the pass or fail decision, retail restrictions, a full record, a one-click inspection report, and a re-check of existing clients.

- **It is already required,** so firms have a budget and a real inspection risk
- **It uses every part of the engine:** onboarding, decision, record and report
- **It is narrow,** so we can ship it in months, not years
- **The buyers can be named:** about 38 licensed firms on a public list

> **To be confirmed by customers.** This is our working choice from research. Before we raise, we need written trial interest from compliance heads at three firms. If they need a different check first, we change the first product, not the engine.

06 Why banks hold back, and the part we solve

BARRIER	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW IT IS SOLVED
Capital	Under Basel rules from January 2026, a bank holding bitcoin on its own balance sheet must hold capital equal to the full amount (a 1,250% risk weight)	Offer it as agent, not owner
Custody and money laundering	Safekeeping and anti-money-laundering controls	Licensed partners, available today
Client checks	Proving each client may buy each product, up to what limit	**Quolin**

07 How we sell, competition and pricing

How we sell. Direct to heads of compliance, starting from the public list of Singapore licensees and our own network. Every customer starts with a pilot, then runs Quolin beside their current process for eight weeks before switching. Later, trading-platform providers and compliance consultancies can resell us.

CATEGORY	PLAYERS	RELATIONSHIP TO QUOLIN
Adviser tools	Saturn ($15m Series A, 2025), Aveni, Timeline	Make human advisers faster
Risk profilers	Oxford Risk, Dynamic Planner	Partners for profiling
Trading rails	Bitpanda Enterprise, Coinbase, Zerohash	Channel partners
Rules as code	Droit, now part of FIS (March 2026)	Proof of demand; largest threat

We have not found anyone selling automated client checks for digital-asset distribution in Asia-Pacific. **Pricing hypothesis:** an annual licence of £30-60k plus £0.50-2 per client checked; £150-400k a year per country for banks. Never a share of trading.

08 Team

Volodymyr Romanenko
CO-FOUNDER · PRODUCT AND STRATEGY

Originated the concept and wrote the first prototype. IMC (CFA UK). Eton music scholar; Risman Scholar, Royal College of Music.

Su-Lee Oei
CO-FOUNDER · FINANCE AND INSTITUTIONS

Three decades in institutional finance across Asia-Pacific. CA ANZ, GAICD, Qualified Risk Director.

Daniel Fleming
TECHNICAL LEAD

Financial-markets engineer: risk, reconciliation and analytics systems. Leads the build from Sydney.

09 The ask: £800,000 to launch in Singapore and prepare Australia

USE OF FUNDS, 18 MONTHS	£
Founders, £25-30k a year each, plus employer costs	**136k**
Two senior engineers, Sydney, from months 3 and 9	**218k**
Legal opinions and signed rules, SG and AU	**124k**
Security certification, testing, insurance	**71k**
Company, payroll, travel, cloud and tools	**90k**
Contingency, 10%	**64k**
Runway buffer, about 2.5 extra months	**97k**
Total	**800k**

WHEN	WHAT THE MONEY MUST PRODUCE
Before close	Written trial interest from three regulated firms
Month 3	Singapore legal opinion; signed assessment
Month 6	First paying Singapore firm live
Month 12	SOC 2 Type II security report; Australian rules signed
Month 18	Two or three paying firms; first bank in a pilot

Equity terms open for discussion. Hong Kong, the UK and the EU are the next round's work.

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